Chapter 90 — Rendering Performance & Jank in Compose

> **Part X — Performance, Observability & Quality** · Complexity: **Complex** (≥40 interview questions)
>
> **Prerequisites:** Ch 2 (Compose/UDF), Ch 85 (perf monitoring/JankStats), Ch 89 (memory/GC), Ch 93 (lists/LazyColumn), Ch 3 (threading), Ch 44 (lifecycle). Pairs with Ch 88 (cold start), Ch 92 (baseline profiles).
>
> **Reference surface in StreamCart:** keeping the UI **smooth** — rendering every frame within the **frame budget** (≈16ms at 60Hz, ≈8–11ms at 90/120Hz) so there's no **jank** (dropped/slow frames) or **frozen frames** (>700ms) — by understanding Compose's **recomposition** model, making state **stable** and reads **narrow**, keeping work **off the composition/UI thread** (Ch 3), and **measuring** with the **Layout Inspector recomposition counts**, **Compose compiler metrics**, **JankStats** (field, Ch 85), and **Macrobenchmark** `FrameTimingMetric` (Ch 92).

90.1 Problem Definition and Real-World Context

Smoothness is **perceived quality**: the UI thread must produce each frame within the **frame budget** — **~16.7ms at 60Hz** (less at 90/120Hz) — or the frame is **dropped/late** (**jank**), and a frame over **700ms** is a **frozen frame** (Ch 85). In **Jetpack Compose** (Ch 2), the dominant cause of jank is **recomposition problems**: recomposing **too much** (unstable parameters, broad state reads, no `remember`), doing **expensive work in composition** (sorting/allocating/IO on the composition thread), and **janky lists** (Ch 93). **Rendering performance & jank** is the discipline of keeping every frame within budget: understanding the **compose phases** (composition → layout → draw) and the **recomposition** model, making state **stable** and reads **deferred/narrow**, **hoisting** work out of composition and **off the main thread** (Ch 3), avoiding **per-frame allocations** (GC jank, Ch 89), and **measuring** recomposition and frame timing rigorously. Jank is the most **visible** perf problem — users feel stutter immediately.

Concretely, teams hit:

- **Over-recomposition.** A composable recomposes far more than needed because a parameter is **unstable** (an unstable type, a lambda recreated each time, a `List` instead of a stable/ immutable type) or it **reads state too broadly** — so the whole subtree recomposes on every change. The #1 Compose jank source.
- **Unstable parameters / types.** Compose can **skip** a composable if its parameters are **stable** and unchanged. A **mutable** or **unknown-stability** type (a plain `class`, a raw `List`, a lambda capturing unstable state) marks it **unstable** → it **can't skip** → recomposes every time. Fix with **stable/immutable** types (`@Immutable`/`@Stable`, `ImmutableList`, stable collections) and **remembered lambdas**.
- **Broad state reads.** Reading a `State`/`StateFlow` **high** in the tree (and passing values down) recomposes the **whole subtree**; reading it **low** (at the leaf that needs it), or **deferring** the read (lambda/`derivedStateOf`), narrows recomposition. Read state **as low and as late as possible**.
- **Expensive work in composition.** Composition runs on a thread that **blocks frames** — sorting, filtering, allocating, formatting, or (worst) **I/O** in the composable body runs on **every recomposition** and blows the budget. **Hoist** it: compute in the `ViewModel`/off- main (Ch 3), `remember` the result, pass stable inputs.

- **Missing `remember` / `derivedStateOf`.** Recomputing a derived value every recomposition (instead of `remember` / `derivedStateOf`) wastes the budget; `remember` caches across recompositions, `derivedStateOf` recomputes **only when inputs change**.
- **Janky lists (Ch 93).** `LazyColumn` without stable **`key`s**, with unstable items, heavy item composables, or synchronous image decode (Ch 59) janks on scroll — covered in depth in Ch 93.
- **Per-frame allocations → GC jank (Ch 89).** Allocating in composition or `onDraw` churns the GC → pauses → dropped frames (Ch 89). Hoist allocations.
- **The compose phases & where time goes. Composition** (what to show — recomposition), **layout** (measure/place), **draw**. Jank can be in any phase; most Compose jank is **excessive recomposition** + **expensive composition**, but deep layout and overdraw matter too. **Measure** to know which.
- **Measuring recomposition & frames. Layout Inspector** shows **recomposition/skip counts** per composable; the **Compose compiler metrics** report **stability** (which params/types are unstable); **JankStats** (Ch 85) measures **field** jank; **Macrobenchmark** **`FrameTimingMetric`** (Ch 92) measures frame durations in the lab. Don't guess — measure.
- **First-run jank (JIT, Ch 92).** On first runs, composition code is interpreted/JIT → slower → more first-scroll jank. **Baseline Profiles** (Ch 92) AOT-compile Compose + scroll paths → smoother from first launch.

The architecture: keep every frame within the **frame budget** by minimizing **recomposition** — make parameters/state **stable/immutable** (`@Immutable` / `@Stable`, immutable collections, remembered lambdas) so composables can **skip**; **read state as low and late as possible** (leaf reads, lambda deferral, `derivedStateOf`); **hoist expensive work out of composition** and **off the main thread** (ViewModel/Dispatchers.IO, Ch 3), `remember`ing results; **avoid per- frame allocations** (GC jank, Ch 89); optimize **lists** with stable keys + light items (Ch 93); **AOT-compile** the render path (Baseline Profiles, Ch 92); and **measure** with Layout Inspector recomposition counts, compose compiler stability metrics, **JankStats** (field, Ch 85), and **Macrobenchmark** **`FrameTimingMetric`** (lab, Ch 92). This chapter is about **keeping the UI smooth**.

Three practical use cases

1. **Kill over-recomposition (StreamCart).** The product card recomposed on every unrelated state change because it took a raw `List` and a fresh lambda; Layout Inspector showed thousands of recompositions. Fix: `ImmutableList` + remembered callback + `@Immutable` model → recompositions drop ~95%, scroll is smooth (Ch 93).
2. **Hoist expensive composition.** A screen sorted/filtered a list **in the composable body** every recomposition. Fix: move to the `ViewModel` (off-main, Ch 3), expose stable state, `remember` derived values → frame budget restored.
3. **Smooth first scroll (Ch 92).** First-scroll jank from JIT-cold Compose; a Baseline Profile covering the feed scroll (Ch 92) AOT-compiles it → smooth from first launch, verified by Macrobenchmark `FrameTimingMetric`.

Why this is architectural

Rendering performance composes Compose's recomposition model (Ch 2), memory/GC (Ch 89), lists (Ch 93), threading (Ch 3), baseline profiles (Ch 92), and measurement (JankStats + Macrobenchmark, Ch 85/92). The decisions — stable state, narrow reads, hoisted work, allocation discipline, AOT-compiled render path, rigorous measurement — determine whether the UI is smooth, which is the most visible dimension of quality.

90.2 Requirements Engineering

Functional requirements

ID	Requirement
F1	Render every frame within the frame budget (~16ms/60Hz, less at 90/120Hz); no jank/frozen frames.
F2	Minimize recomposition: stable/immutable params + skippable composables.
F3	Read state as low and late as possible (leaf reads, deferral, derivedStateOf).
F4	Hoist expensive work out of composition and off the main thread (Ch 3).
F5	Avoid per-frame allocations (GC jank, Ch 89); optimize lists (Ch 93).
F6	Measure: Layout Inspector counts, compiler stability, JankStats (field), Macrobenchmark frames (Ch 85/92).

Non-functional requirements

Attribute	Policy
Smoothness	Within frame budget; low jank/frozen-frame rate (Ch 85).
Efficiency	Minimal recomposition; hoisted work.
Measured	Recomposition counts + field jank + lab frames (Ch 85/92).
Device coverage	Smooth on low-end (not just flagship, Ch 85).
No regression	Macrobenchmark frame gate (Ch 92).

Scope

- **In scope:** frame budget + jank/frozen frames (Ch 85), compose phases (composition/layout/ draw), recomposition model + skipping, stability (`@Immutable` / `@Stable` , immutable collections, remembered lambdas), narrow/deferred state reads (leaf, `derivedStateOf`), hoisting work off composition + off-main (Ch 3), `remember` / `derivedStateOf` , per-frame allocations (GC jank, Ch 89), list jank pointer (Ch 93), measurement (Layout Inspector, compiler metrics, JankStats, Macrobenchmark `FrameTimingMetric` , Ch 85/92), baseline profiles pointer (Ch 92).
- **Out of scope:** Compose basics/UDF (Ch 2), perf monitoring pipeline (Ch 85), memory detail (Ch 89), list detail (Ch 93), baseline-profile mechanics (Ch 92), threading detail (Ch 3).

Assumptions & constraints

- Jetpack Compose (Ch 2) with the Compose compiler; UDF with `ViewModel` + `StateFlow` (Ch 2). Measured with Layout Inspector (recomposition counts), compose compiler metrics (stability), JankStats (field, Ch 85), Macrobenchmark `FrameTimingMetric` (lab, Ch 92). Target smooth on **representative** devices. `minSdk 24` .

90.3 System Design Fundamentals

- **The frame budget & jank (Ch 85).** The display refreshes at **60/90/120Hz**; each frame must be produced in **1/refresh** seconds (**~16.7ms at 60Hz**, ~11ms at 90Hz, ~8ms at 120Hz). Miss it → the frame is **late/dropped** (**jank** — visible stutter); a frame **>700ms** is a **frozen frame** (Ch 85). The UI/composition thread does composition + layout + draw dispatch within this budget — any heavy work on it janks.
- **The compose phases.** Compose renders in three phases: **composition** (run composables to decide *what* to show — this is where **recomposition** happens), **layout** (measure + place), **draw** (issue draw commands). Recomposition re-runs (parts of) composition when state changes. Jank can be in any phase, but **most Compose jank is excessive/expensive recomposition** (plus deep layout and overdraw). Measure to locate it.
- **Recomposition & skipping (the core model).** When observed state changes, Compose **recomposes** the composables that **read** it. Compose can **skip** a composable (not re-run it) if **all its parameters are stable and unchanged** — this is the key to performance. **Smart recomposition** re-runs only what's affected. The goal: **maximize skipping** by making parameters stable and reads narrow, so a change recomposes **only the leaf** that depends on it.
- **Stability — why composables don't skip.** Compose marks a type **stable** if it's immutable or its mutations are observable (`@Immutable` / `@Stable`, primitives, stable collections). An **unstable** parameter — a **mutable** class, a type of **unknown stability** (a class from a module without the Compose compiler), a raw `List` / `Map` / `Set` (interface — unknown stability), or a **lambda recreated** each recomposition — makes the composable **unskippable** → it recomposes **every time** the parent does. **Fixes:** `@Immutable` / `@Stable` on models, **immutable collections** (`kotlinx.collections.immutable` `ImmutableList`), **remembered** lambdas (or stable method refs), and keeping unstable types out of composable params. The **Compose compiler stability metrics** report exactly which params/types are unstable.
- **Narrow & deferred state reads. Where** you read state determines **what** recomposes. Reading state **high** and passing values down recomposes the **whole subtree**. Reading it **low** (at the leaf that uses it), or **deferring** the read behind a **lambda** (e.g., `Modifier.offset { ... }`, `graphicsLayer { ... }` — read in layout/draw, not composition) or `derivedStateOf` (recompute only when the *derived* value changes), **narrows** recomposition. **Read state as low and as late as possible.**
- **Hoist expensive work out of composition + off-main (Ch 3).** The composable body runs on **every recomposition** — so **sorting, filtering, formatting, allocating, or I/O** there is catastrophic. **Hoist** computation to the `ViewModel` / a **background dispatcher** (Ch 3), expose **ready, stable state**, and `remember` any per-composition derived value. Never do blocking/IO work in a composable (Ch 3).
- **`remember` and `derivedStateOf`.** `remember` caches a value **across recompositions** (compute once, reuse) — use it for any non-trivial derived/created object. `derivedStateOf` wraps a computation that reads state and **recomputes only when its result changes** (not on every input change) — use it when a frequently-changing state drives a rarely-changing derived value (e.g., `isScrolled = derivedStateOf { listState.firstVisibleItemIndex > 0 }`). Together they cut recomposition cost.
- **Per-frame allocations → GC jank (Ch 89).** Allocating in composition, `onDraw`, or a tight loop churns the **GC**, whose pauses **drop frames** (Ch 89). Hoist/`remember` allocations; avoid creating lambdas/collections/objects on the hot path.
- **Lists (Ch 93).** `LazyColumn` / `LazyRow` jank — missing stable `key`**s**, unstable items, heavy item content, sync image decode (Ch 59) — is the most common scroll-jank source, covered in depth in **Ch 93**. The same principles (stability, keys, light items, async images) apply.
- **Baseline Profiles for the render path (Ch 92).** First-run composition/scroll is **JIT-cold** → janky; a **Baseline Profile** covering launch + key scrolls (Ch 92) **AOT-compiles** the Compose runtime + your render path →

smoother from the first launch. Pair with R8 (Ch 92).

- **Measurement (don't guess). Layout Inspector → recomposition + skip counts** per composable (find the over-recomposing one). **Compose compiler metrics → stability report** (which params are unstable, why skipping fails). **JankStats** (Ch 85) → **field** jank/frozen rate per screen. **Macrobenchmark** `FrameTimingMetric` (Ch 92) → **lab** frame durations (CI gate). **System trace (Perfetto)** → where the frame time goes. Measure, then optimize the thing that's actually slow.

Core insight: **keep every frame within the budget (~16ms at 60Hz, less at 90/120Hz — a late frame is jank, a >700ms frame is frozen, Ch 85) by minimizing recomposition: make composables skippable by giving them stable/immutable parameters (@Immutable/@Stable models, immutable collections instead of raw List/Map, remembered lambdas instead of freshly-allocated ones — the Compose compiler stability metrics tell you exactly which params are unstable and why), read state as low and as late as possible (leaf reads, lambda/graphicsLayer deferral so the read happens in layout/draw not composition, and derivedStateOf so a frequently-changing state only recomposes when the derived result changes), hoist all expensive work — sorting, filtering, formatting, and above all I/O — out of the composable body (which re-runs on every recomposition) into the ViewModel and off the main thread (Ch 3), caching with remember; avoid per-frame allocations that churn the GC into frame-dropping pauses (Ch 89); apply the same stability + stable-key + light-item discipline to lists (Ch 93); AOT-compile the composition and scroll paths with Baseline Profiles + R8 so the first run isn't JIT-janky (Ch 92); and measure with Layout Inspector recomposition counts, the compiler stability report, JankStats in the field (Ch 85), and Macrobenchmark FrameTimingMetric in the lab (Ch 92) rather than guessing — because jank is the most visible quality defect and the tail (low-end, first scroll) is where it's felt.**

90.4 High-Level Architecture



Components & ownership

- **Frame budget** sets the deadline; **compose phases** (composition/layout/draw) do the work.
- **Minimize recomposition:** stable params (skippable), narrow/deferred reads, hoisted work (Ch 3), no per-frame allocation (Ch 89).
- **Lists** (Ch 93); **AOT** render path (Ch 92); **measure** (Layout Inspector + JankStats + Macrobenchmark, Ch 85/92).

Direction: frame budget → compose phases → minimize/cheapen recomposition (stable + narrow + hoisted + no-alloc) → smooth; measured by counts + field + lab.

90.5 Detailed Component Design



Component	Responsibility
`StableState`	immutable models + collections + remembered lambdas → skippable
`NarrowRead`	leaf reads, `derivedStateOf`, lambda deferral → narrow recomposition
`HoistedWork`	compute off composition + off-main (Ch 3); `remember` results
`Measurement`	Layout Inspector counts, stability report, JankStats (Ch 85), FrameTiming (Ch 92)

90.6 End-to-End Data Flow

State change → recomposition (skip vs re-run)


State change → recomposition (skip vs re-run)

Hoist expensive work out of composition


Hoist expensive work out of composition

90.7 Complete Kotlin Implementation

Package: `com.streamcart.ui`.

90.7.1 Stable params → skippable composable

```
@Immutable                                                  // stable -> enables skipping
data class ProductUi(val id: String, val title: String, val price: String, val imageUrl: String)

@Composable
fun ProductCard(
    product: ProductUi,                                     // @Immutable -> stable
    onClick: (String) -> Unit,                              // pass a STABLE/remembered lambda
(see caller)
) {
    // Skippable: if `product` is unchanged and `onClick` is stable, Compose SKIPS this on
recomposition.
    Card(Modifier.clickable { onClick(product.id) }) { /* ... */ }
}

@Composable
fun Feed(items: ImmutableList<ProductUi>, onClick: (String) -> Unit) {   // ImmutableList, NOT
List (stable)
    LazyColumn {
        items(items, key = { it.id }) { product ->          // stable keys (Ch 93)
            ProductCard(product, onClick)                   // onClick is hoisted/stable ->
cards skip
        }
    }
}
```

90.7.2 Narrow + deferred reads (derivedStateOf, lambda defer)

```
@Composable
fun FeedWithFab(listState: LazyListState) {
    // derivedStateOf: recomposes the FAB ONLY when crossing the threshold, not every scroll
pixel
    val showFab by remember { derivedStateOf { listState.firstVisibleItemIndex > 3 } }
    if (showFab) ScrollToTopFab()

    // Lambda/graphicsLayer defer: read scroll offset in the DRAW phase, not composition -> no
recomposition
    Box(Modifier.graphicsLayer { translationY = listState.firstVisibleItemScrollOffset * 0.5f })
// parallax
}
```

90.7.3 Hoist expensive work off composition + off-main (Ch 3)

```
// BAD: sort/filter in the composable body - runs on EVERY recomposition, blocks the frame
@Composable fun BadList(all: List<ProductUi>, query: String) {
    val filtered = all.filter { it.title.contains(query) }.sortedBy { it.price }   // every
recomposition!
    LazyColumn { items(filtered) { ProductCard(it, {}) } }
}

// GOOD: compute in the ViewModel, off-main (Ch 3); expose ready, stable state
class FeedViewModel @Inject constructor(private val repo: FeedRepository) : ViewModel() {
    val uiState: StateFlow<ImmutableList<ProductUi>> = combine(repo.products, query) { all, q ->
        all.filter { it.title.contains(q) }.sortedBy { it.price }.toImmutableList()
    }.flowOn(Dispatchers.Default)                                                    // off-main
(Ch 3)
     .stateIn(viewModelScope, SharingStarted.WhileSubscribed(5000), persistentListOf())
}
@Composable fun GoodList(vm: FeedViewModel) {
    val items by vm.uiState.collectAsStateWithLifecycle()                           // ready
state - cheap composition
    Feed(items, remember { vm::onClick })                                           // remembered
lambda - stable
}
```

90.7.4 remember to avoid recomputation/allocation (Ch 89)

```
@Composable
fun FormattedPrice(cents: Long) {
    // remember: build the formatter ONCE, not every recomposition (avoids allocation -> GC
jank, Ch 89)
    val formatter = remember { NumberFormat.getCurrencyInstance() }
    val text = remember(cents) { formatter.format(cents / 100.0) }                  // recompute
only when cents change
    Text(text)
}
```

90.7.5 Measurement: Macrobenchmark FrameTimingMetric (lab, Ch 92)

```
@RunWith(AndroidJUnit4::class)
class ScrollBenchmark {
    @get:Rule val rule = MacrobenchmarkRule()
    @Test fun feedScroll() = rule.measureRepeated(
        packageName = "com.streamcart", metrics = listOf(FrameTimingMetric()),     // frame
durations (jank)
        compilationMode = CompilationMode.Partial(), iterations = 10,              // with
baseline profile (Ch 92)
        startupMode = null,
    ) { startActivityAndWait(); device.findObject(By.res("feed")).fling(Direction.DOWN) }
    // CI GATE: fail if frameDurationCpuMs p95 regresses. Field jank -> JankStats/vitals (Ch
85).
}
// Dev: Layout Inspector recomposition counts; enable compose compiler metrics for the stability
report.
```

90.7.6 Module structure

```
:feature:feed  Feed/ProductCard (stable params), FeedViewModel (hoisted, off-main)
# Stability -> @Immutable + ImmutableList + remembered lambdas; narrow reads ->
derivedStateOf/lambda defer;
# lists -> Ch 93; allocations -> Ch 89; AOT -> Baseline Profiles + R8 (Ch 92);
# measure -> Layout Inspector + compiler metrics + JankStats (Ch 85) + Macrobenchmark
FrameTiming (Ch 92).
```

90.8 Concurrency and Race Conditions

Scenario	Risk	Handling
Work in composition thread	blocks frame	hoist to ViewModel off-main (Ch 3)
Unstable param	no skip, over-recompose	@Immutable / ImmutableList / remembered lambda
Broad state read	whole subtree recomposes	leaf read / derivedStateOf / defer
Per-frame allocation	GC jank	remember / hoist (Ch 89)
Fresh lambda each recomposition	unstable param	remember / stable method ref
Sync image decode in item	scroll jank	async loader (Coil, Ch 59/93)
IO in composable	frame stall + wrong thread	never — ViewModel/IO (Ch 3)

- **Composition is on the frame-critical thread** — any blocking/IO/heavy compute there **directly** causes jank. The UDF discipline (Ch 2) — compute in the `ViewModel` off-main (Ch 3), expose ready state — is also the

performance discipline.

- **Stability is a contract** — an unstable param silently disables skipping, so a far-away state change recomposes composables that didn't change. The **compiler stability report** makes this visible; immutable types + remembered lambdas restore skipping.
- `derivedStateOf` **prevents recomposition storms** — a rapidly-changing state (scroll offset) driving a rarely-changing derived value (is-scrolled) would otherwise recompose every frame; `derivedStateOf` gates it.

90.9 Failure Scenarios and Recovery

Failure	Detection	Response	Outcome
Over-recomposition	Layout Inspector counts	stable params + narrow reads	skips restored
Expensive composition	Perfetto/traces	hoist off-main (Ch 3) + remember	cheap composition
GC jank	allocation profiler (Ch 89)	hoist allocations	smooth
Scroll jank	JankStats (Ch 85)	stable keys + light items + async images (Ch 93/59)	smooth scroll
First-scroll jank	Macrobenchmark None vs Partial	Baseline Profile (Ch 92)	AOT smooth
Unstable param	compiler stability report	@Immutable / ImmutableList / remember	skippable
Low-end jank	field p95 (Ch 85)	optimize + measure on real devices	honest


90.9 Failure Scenarios and Recovery

> **Make composables skippable, read state narrowly, hoist the work, and measure.** Compose jank is over-recomposition (stable params + narrow reads fix it), expensive composition (hoist off-main + remember fix it), GC pauses (hoist allocations, Ch 89), and list/first-run jank (stable keys + baseline profiles, Ch 93/92). Don't guess — use Layout Inspector recomposition counts, the compiler stability report, JankStats in the field (Ch 85), and Macrobenchmark FrameTimingMetric in the lab (Ch 92).

90.10 Scaling the Implementation

- **Level 1.** UDF with `collectAsStateWithLifecycle` (Ch 2); `remember` derived values; no IO in composables (Ch 3).
- **Level 2.** Stable params (`@Immutable` , `ImmutableList` , remembered lambdas); narrow reads + `derivedStateOf` ; stable list keys (Ch 93).
- **Level 3 — production.** Compose compiler stability metrics in CI; Layout Inspector audits; JankStats field monitoring (Ch 85); Baseline Profiles + R8 (Ch 92).
- **Level 4 — large.** Macrobenchmark `FrameTimingMetric` CI gates per key screen; jank budgets by device class (Ch 85); strong-skipping mode; module-wide stability hygiene.

- **Level 5 — enterprise.** Jank SLOs with error budgets, automated frame-regression gating, per-flow baseline profiles (Ch 92), device-tiered rendering, continuous field jank dashboards (Ch 85).

Avoid overengineering: stable params + narrow reads + hoisted work + stable keys + baseline profiles, measured with Layout Inspector and JankStats, gets most of the smoothness. Don't micro-optimize before measuring; don't put work in composition; don't use raw `List`/fresh lambdas in hot composables.

90.11 Alternative Approaches and Trade-offs

Dimension	Option A	Option B	When
Params	Stable/immutable (skippable)	raw List / fresh lambda	Stable (enable skipping)
State read	Narrow/deferred (derivedStateOf)	broad/high	Narrow (less recomposition)
Work	Hoisted off-main (Ch 3)	in composition	Hoisted (cheap composition)
Derived value	remember / derivedStateOf	recompute each time	remember (cache)
Allocations	Hoisted (Ch 89)	per-frame	Hoisted (no GC jank)
First run	Baseline Profile (Ch 92)	JIT	Baseline profile (smooth first)
Optimize by	Measurement (Ch 85/92)	guessing	Measure first

Stable/immutable params vs raw `List`/fresh lambdas: a raw `List` (interface — unknown stability) or a lambda **recreated each recomposition** marks a composable **unskippable**, so it recomposes on **every** parent recomposition — a silent, widespread jank source. **Immutable collections** + `@Immutable`/`@Stable` models + **remembered lambdas** make composables **skippable**. The compiler stability report shows which to fix. Always prefer stable params in hot composables.

Hoisting vs work-in-composition: computing in the composable body runs it on **every recomposition** on the **frame-critical thread** — catastrophic for sorting/filtering/IO. **Hoisting** to the `ViewModel` off-main (Ch 3), exposing ready state, and `remember`ing derived values makes composition **cheap**. Never compute heavily (and never do IO) in composition.

Measurement vs guessing: optimizing by intuition wastes effort on the wrong thing. **Layout Inspector** (recomposition counts), **compiler stability metrics** (why skipping fails), **JankStats** (field, Ch 85), and **Macrobenchmark** `FrameTimingMetric` (lab, Ch 92) tell you **what's actually slow and where**. Measure first, optimize the real bottleneck, verify.

90.12 Security & Privacy Considerations

- **No sensitive data in recomposition logs/traces (Ch 28):** recomposition counts and frame traces are **structural/timing**, not content — keep PII out of any custom perf logging (Ch 85/ 28).
- **Screen content in overdraw/debug tools stays local:** Layout Inspector/debug overlays are **dev-only**; don't ship debug rendering that could expose content.
- **Baseline profiles contain method names, not data (Ch 92):** compilation hints, not secrets.

- **Field jank metrics PII-safe (Ch 85):** JankStats reports **screen + timing**, not user content (Ch 28).
- **Sensitive screens render like any other:** performance work doesn't change the **secure- surface** handling (e.g., `FLAG_SECURE` on payment screens, Ch 76) — orthogonal concern.
- Client-only concern: rendering is **client-side**; the cross-cutting note is keeping perf logging/traces PII-safe (Ch 85/28).

90.13 Performance and Resource Optimization

- **This chapter *is* rendering performance** — summary: **skippable composables** (stable params), **narrow/deferred reads** (`derivedStateOf` , lambda defer), **hoist work off composition + off-main** (Ch 3), **`remember`** derived/allocated values, **no per-frame allocations** (Ch 89), **stable list keys + light items** (Ch 93), **Baseline Profiles + R8** (Ch 92).
- **Measure before optimizing** — Layout Inspector counts, compiler stability, Perfetto traces, Macrobenchmark frames (Ch 92); don't guess.
- **Target low-end + high-refresh** — the budget is **tighter** at 90/120Hz and work is **slower** on low-end; optimize for the **p95** (Ch 85).
- **Defer reads to layout/draw** — `graphicsLayer` / `offset { }` lambdas read state **without recomposing**.
- **Strong skipping / stability** — keep hot composables' params stable; use the stability report.
- **Profiling:** recomposition/skip counts, frame duration p95 (JankStats field, FrameTiming lab), GC pauses (Ch 89), composition vs layout vs draw time (Perfetto), stability report.

90.14 Testing Strategy

Frame timing is measured (Macrobenchmark); recomposition is inspected; stability is reported by the compiler.

```
class ScrollFrameBenchmark {   // lab gate (Ch 92)
    @get:Rule val rule = MacrobenchmarkRule()
    @Test fun feedScroll_frames() = rule.measureRepeated(
        packageName = "com.streamcart", metrics = listOf(FrameTimingMetric()),
        compilationMode = CompilationMode.Partial(), iterations = 10, startupMode = null,
    ) { startActivityAndWait(); scrollFeed() }   // assert frameDurationCpuMs p95 within budget
}

// Dev checks (not asserted in unit tests, but part of the workflow):
//  - Layout Inspector: recomposition count on ProductCard should be ~1 per data change, not per unrelated change
//  - Compose compiler metrics: enable -> stability report shows ProductUi @Immutable, params stable
//  - StrictMode / no-IO-in-composition: ensure ViewModel does the work (Ch 3)

@Test fun `derivedStateOf gates recomposition`() { /* showFab flips only across the threshold */ }
```

What to test: Macrobenchmark `FrameTimingMetric` on key scrolls (lab gate, p95 within budget, Ch 92); recomposition counts (Layout Inspector — minimal, dev); compiler stability report (params stable); `derivedStateOf` / `remember` gating; no IO in composition (Ch 3); field jank via JankStats (Ch 85).

90.15 Production Observability

- **Metrics: jank rate** + **frozen-frame rate** per screen (JankStats, field, Ch 85), **frame-duration percentiles** (Macrobenchmark lab, Ch 92), recomposition counts (dev), GC pause correlation (Ch 89), first-scroll jank (baseline-profile effect, Ch 92).
- **Logs/traces:** Perfetto frame traces (dev), JankStats events (field) — **PII-safe** (Ch 28/ 85).
- **Debugging:** janky screen → JankStats (which screen, Ch 85) → Layout Inspector (over- recomposing composable?) → compiler stability (unstable param?) → Perfetto (composition/layout/ draw time?); GC jank → allocation profiler (Ch 89); first-scroll jank → `None` vs `Partial` (Ch 92); low-end → field p95 (Ch 85).
- **Alerting:** jank/frozen-frame-rate **regression** release-over-release (Ch 85/41); frame p95 budget breach (Macrobenchmark CI, Ch 92).
- **Dashboards:** jank/frozen rate by screen/device/release; frame percentiles; first-scroll jank; recomposition hotspots (dev).

90.16 System Design Interview Preparation

> ≥40 questions (Complex).

Fundamentals

1. *Frame budget?* ~16.7ms@60Hz, ~11ms@90Hz, ~8ms@120Hz.
2. *Jank?* A late/dropped frame; >700ms = frozen (Ch 85).
3. *Compose phases?* Composition → layout → draw.
4. *Recomposition?* Re-running composables that read changed state.
5. *#1 Compose jank?* Excessive/expensive recomposition.

Recomposition/skipping

6. *Skipping?* Compose skips a composable if params are stable + unchanged.
7. *Smart recomposition?* Re-run only affected readers.
8. *Why not skip?* Unstable parameter.
9. *Goal?* Maximize skipping; recompose only the leaf.

Stability

10. *Stable type?* Immutable or observably mutable (`@Immutable` / `@Stable` , primitives).
11. *Unstable examples?* Mutable class, raw `List` / `Map` , fresh lambda, unknown-stability type.
12. *Fix collections?* `ImmutableList` (kotlinx.collections.immutable).
13. *Fix lambdas?* `remember` / stable method ref.
14. *Find instability?* Compose compiler stability metrics.

15. *@Immutable vs @Stable?* Immutable (never changes) vs stable (changes observable).

State reads

16. *Narrow read?* Read at the leaf that uses it.
17. *Defer read?* Lambda/ `graphicsLayer` / `offset { }` — read in layout/draw.
18. *derivedStateOf?* Recompute only when the derived result changes.
19. *Example?* `isScrolled = derivedStateOf { index > 0 }`.
20. *Read high vs low?* Low — narrows recomposition.

Work/hoisting

21. *Work in composition?* Runs every recomposition — hoist it.
22. *Where?* ViewModel, off-main (Ch 3).
23. *IO in composable?* Never (Ch 3).
24. *remember?* Cache across recompositions.

Allocations/GC

25. *Per-frame alloc?* GC jank — hoist/remember (Ch 89).
26. *onDraw allocations?* Hoist out (Ch 89).

Lists

27. *List jank?* Stable keys + light items + async images (Ch 93).
28. *key?* Stable identity so items aren't recomposed/moved wrongly (Ch 93).
29. *Heavy item?* Lighten / defer (Ch 93).

Baseline profiles

30. *First-scroll jank?* JIT-cold — Baseline Profile (Ch 92).
31. *What it does?* AOT-compile render path (Ch 92).

Measurement

32. *Recomposition counts?* Layout Inspector.
33. *Stability?* Compiler metrics.
34. *Field jank?* JankStats (Ch 85).
35. *Lab frames?* Macrobenchmark `FrameTimingMetric` (Ch 92).
36. *Where time goes?* Perfetto/system trace.

Edge cases/production

37. *High-refresh?* Tighter budget (8–11ms).
38. *Low-end jank?* Field p95 (Ch 85).
39. *Regression gate?* Macrobenchmark frames CI (Ch 92).
40. *Overdraw?* Too many layers drawn — flatten.
41. *Deep layout?* Flatten/ `SubcomposeLayout` carefully.
42. *Measure first?* Always — optimize the real bottleneck.

Design-change challenges

1. **Kill over-recomposition in a card.** Stable params (@Immutable + ImmutableList + remembered lambda).
2. **Smooth a janky filtered list.** Hoist filter/sort off-main (Ch 3) + stable keys (Ch 93).
3. **Stop a recomposition storm on scroll.** `derivedStateOf` / lambda defer.
4. **Fix first-scroll jank.** Baseline Profiles + R8 (Ch 92).
5. **Gate frame regressions in CI.** Macrobenchmark `FrameTimingMetric` (Ch 92) + field JankStats (Ch 85).

Mock walkthrough (abridged)

Clarify (which screen janks? measured how? device targets?) → frame budget + phases (Ch 85) → measure (Layout Inspector counts, compiler stability, JankStats/Perfetto) → minimize recomposition: stable params (@Immutable, ImmutableList, remembered lambdas) + narrow/deferred reads (derivedStateOf, lambda defer) → hoist work off composition + off-main (Ch 3) + remember → no per-frame allocations (Ch 89) → lists (stable keys + light items + async images, Ch 93/59) → Baseline Profiles + R8 (Ch 92) → verify with Macrobenchmark frames (lab) + field JankStats (Ch 85/92) → observability (jank by screen/device).

90.17 Practical Exercises

1. **Beginner.** Enable the Compose compiler stability metrics; find an unstable param on a hot composable and fix it (`@Immutable` + `ImmutableList` + remembered lambda). *Eval:* composable becomes skippable; recomposition count drops.
2. **Intermediate.** Move a sort/filter out of a composable body into the `ViewModel` off-main (Ch 3) and add `derivedStateOf` for a scroll-driven flag. *Eval:* cheap composition; no recomposition storm.
3. **Advanced.** Add a Baseline Profile covering feed scroll (Ch 92) and measure the frame delta with Macrobenchmark `FrameTimingMetric` (`None` vs `Partial`). *Eval:* first-scroll jank reduced; CI gate added.
4. **Production debugging.** Use JankStats (Ch 85) to find the jankiest screen, then Layout Inspector + Perfetto to locate the cause (over-recomposition? allocation? Ch 89). *Eval:* root cause found and fixed.
5. **System design challenge.** Design a jank budget + CI frame-gating pipeline (Macrobenchmark per screen) + field JankStats dashboards by device class (Ch 85/92). *Eval:* gated, measured, device-tiered.

(Solutions withheld unless requested.)

90.18 Chapter Summary & Reference Sheet

Key decisions: keep the UI smooth by rendering **every frame within the frame budget** (**~16.7ms at 60Hz**, ~11ms at 90Hz, ~8ms at 120Hz — a late frame is **jank**, a **>700ms** frame is **frozen**, Ch 85), which in **Jetpack Compose** (Ch 2) means **minimizing recomposition**: make composables **skippable** by giving them **stable/immutable parameters** (**`@Immutable`** / **`@Stable`** models, **immutable collections** instead of raw `List` / `Map`, **remembered lambdas** instead of freshly-allocated ones — the **Compose compiler stability metrics** report exactly which params are unstable and why skipping fails); **read state as low and as late as possible** (leaf reads, **lambda/ `graphicsLayer` deferral** so the read happens in layout/draw not composition, and **`derivedStateOf`** so a frequently-changing state only recomposes when the **derived result** changes); **hoist all expensive work** — sorting, filtering, formatting, and above all **I/O** — **out of the composable body** (which re-runs on every recomposition) into the **`ViewModel` off the main thread** (Ch

3), caching with `remember`; **avoid per-frame allocations** that churn the GC into frame-dropping pauses (Ch 89); apply the same stability + **stable-key** + light-item discipline to **lists** (Ch 93); **AOT-compile** the composition and scroll paths with **Baseline Profiles + R8** so the first run isn't **JIT-janky** (Ch 92); and **measure** with **Layout Inspector** recomposition counts, the **compiler stability report**, **JankStats** in the field (Ch 85), and **Macrobenchmark** `FrameTimingMetric` in the lab (Ch 92) — rather than guessing, because jank is the **most visible** quality defect and the tail (low-end, first scroll) is where it's felt.

Concepts: frame budget + jank/frozen (Ch 85), compose phases (composition/layout/draw), recomposition + skipping, stability (`@Immutable` / `@Stable`, immutable collections, remembered lambdas, compiler metrics), narrow/deferred reads (leaf, lambda defer, `derivedStateOf`), hoisting off composition + off-main (Ch 3), `remember` / `derivedStateOf`, per-frame allocation → GC jank (Ch 89), lists (Ch 93), Baseline Profiles + R8 (Ch 92), measurement (Layout Inspector, JankStats, Macrobenchmark).

Common mistakes: raw `List`/fresh lambdas in hot composables (unskippable → over- recomposition); broad/high state reads; sorting/filtering/IO **in** composition; recomputing derived values without `remember` / `derivedStateOf`; per-frame allocations (GC jank); janky lists (no stable keys, heavy items, sync images, Ch 93/59); no Baseline Profile (first-scroll JIT jank); optimizing by guessing instead of measuring; testing only on a flagship.

Checklist:

- [ ] stable/immutable params (`@Immutable`, `ImmutableList`, remembered lambdas) → skippable
- [ ] compiler stability metrics enabled (find unstable params)
- [ ] narrow + deferred reads (leaf, `derivedStateOf`, lambda defer)
- [ ] hoist work off composition + off-main (Ch 3); never IO in composition
- [ ] `remember` derived/allocated values
- [ ] no per-frame allocations (Ch 89)
- [ ] stable list keys + light items + async images (Ch 93/59)
- [ ] Baseline Profiles + R8 (Ch 92)
- [ ] Layout Inspector recomposition audit
- [ ] JankStats field (Ch 85) + Macrobenchmark `FrameTimingMetric` lab gate (Ch 92).

Key APIs: `@Immutable` / `@Stable`, `kotlinx.collections.immutable` (`ImmutableList` / `persistentListOf`), `remember` / `remember(key)`, `derivedStateOf`, `collectAsStateWithLifecycle` (Ch 2), `Modifier.graphicsLayer` / `offset { }` (deferred read), `LazyListState` (`firstVisibleItemIndex` / `ScrollOffset`), Compose compiler metrics (stability report), Layout Inspector (recomposition counts), JankStats (field, Ch 85), `MacrobenchmarkRule` + `FrameTimingMetric` + `CompilationMode.Partial` (lab, Ch 92), Perfetto/system trace.

References:

- Compose performance: https://developer.android.com/develop/ui/compose/performance
- Stability & skipping: https://developer.android.com/develop/ui/compose/performance/stability
- Compose compiler metrics: https://developer.android.com/develop/ui/compose/performance/stability/diagnose
- JankStats: https://developer.android.com/topic/performance/jankstats
- Macrobenchmark FrameTimingMetric: https://developer.android.com/topic/performance/benchmarking/macrobenchmark-overview

- (composes) Ch 2 Compose/UDF, Ch 85 Perf/JankStats, Ch 89 Memory/GC, Ch 93 Lists, Ch 3 Threading, Ch 92 Baseline Profiles

Chapter review (Phase 4)

- **Completeness:** all 18 sections; architecture/class/sequence/hoist/failure diagrams; stable- params + narrow-reads + hoist + remember + Macrobenchmark code; concurrency (composition-is- frame-critical, stability-contract, derivedStateOf); failure (skippable+narrow+hoist+measure principle); 5 levels; stable-vs-raw, hoist-vs-in-composition, measure-vs-guess trade-offs; security (PII-safe perf logs); perf (the whole chapter); Macrobenchmark + recomposition + derivedStateOf tests; observability (jank by screen/device); 42 Q&A + 5 challenges. ✅
- **Expand later:** Compose/UDF (Ch 2), lists (Ch 93), memory/GC (Ch 89), baseline profiles (Ch 92), perf monitoring (Ch 85).
- **Interview coverage:** 42 Q&A — exceeds the ≥40 Complex bar.